

Dongkeun Choi

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Education

2027 (expected)	Ph.D. in Economics, University of California San Diego
2021	M.A. in Economics, Korea University, South Korea
2019	B.A. in Economics and B.S. in Financial Engineering, Korea University, South Korea

Research Interests

Macroeconomics, Monetary Economics, Financial Intermediaries

References

James D. Hamilton (*Chair*)

Professor
Department of Economics
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Juan Herreño

Assistant Professor
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Job Market Paper

1. Unintended Risks of Bank Capital Regulations

Abstract. Nonbank financial intermediaries (NBFIs) have reemerged as major U.S. credit suppliers. Using loan-level mortgage data, I document that NBFI-originated loans exhibit looser underwriting standards and higher default rates than bank loans. In addition, tighter capital requirements are associated with both NBFI expansion and a shift toward borrowers with riskier profiles. I develop a general equilibrium model in which banks and NBFIs choose loan rates and underwriting standards. Banks fund their lending with deposits subject to capital requirements, while NBFIs rely on market-based funding outside the regulatory perimeter. Tighter capital requirements shift origination toward NBFIs, raising defaults through changes in the composition of underlying risks. Introducing underwriting regulations governing NBFI lending reduces credit losses more effectively than tightening bank capital requirements.

Working Papers

2. **Equipment, Structures, and the Limits of Investment-Specific Technological Change** with Munseob Lee

Work in Progress

3. **Why Is Monetary Policy Less Effective at Low Interest Rates: The Role of Banking Sector**
4. **Redistribution through the Secondary Mortgage Market**

Research Experience

Summer 2026	Dissertation Fellow, Federal Reserve Board
2022–2023	Research Assistant, Prof. Munseob Lee, UC San Diego
2020–2021	Research Assistant, Prof. Jinill Kim, Korea University

Presentations

2026	Federal Reserve Board, Midwest Macro Meeting (Milwaukee), FIRS (Miami), UCSD
<2025	UCSD, SOCAE

Teaching Experience

2022	Long Run Macroeconomics (UG), Teaching Assistant, UC San Diego
2023–2026	Short Run Macroeconomics (UG), Teaching Assistant, UC San Diego
2023	Macroeconomics B (G), Teaching Assistant, UC San Diego
2023	Macroeconomics C (G), Teaching Assistant, UC San Diego
2020–2021	Intermediate Macroeconomics (UG), Teaching Assistant, Korea University
2020–2021	Macroeconomics I & II (G), Teaching Assistant, Korea University

Fellowships, Grants, and Awards

2026	FIRS PhD Student Travel Grant
2026	Travel and Research Grant, UC San Diego
2025	Clive Granger Research Fellowship, UC San Diego
2024, 2025	Research Fellowships, Prof. James D. Hamilton, UC San Diego
2022, 2023	Summer Research Fellowships, UC San Diego
2021–2022	Regent Fellowship, UC San Diego
2021–2026	Research Grant, Korea Foundation of Abroad Studies (KFAS)
2019–2020	Brain Korea 21+ Graduate Student Scholarship, Korea University
Spring 2017	President's List, Korea University

Additional Information

Programming	Matlab, Dynare, Stata, Python
Languages	English (fluent), Korean (native)
Citizenship	South Korea (F-1 Visa)